Seafood and tomatoes make a flavorful pair in this delicate summer chilled soup. You can use the cooked clams or mussels in another dish, such as potato salad.

crab gazpacho

SERVES 4 **PREP** 30 MINS **COOK** 10 MINS CHILLING 2 HOURS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1lb 2oz (500g) clams or mussels, cleaned
4 tbsp fruity olive oil
1 shallot, finely chopped
2 large scallions, finely chopped
2 garlic cloves, crushed
½ cup dry sherry
3 sprigs flat leaf parsley, plus 1 tbsp finely chopped parsley to finish
1 tsp fennel seeds, crushed
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ tsp hot paprika
2¼lb (1kg) ripe tomatoes, rinsed and halved
3 tbsp olive oil
2 eggs, hard-boiled and peeled
1 tbsp sherry vinegar
freshly cooked brown and white meat of 1 medium prepared crab
8 croûtes (see p39), rubbed with garlic

1 Place a sauté pan over medium heat. Add the clams or mussels along with 1 tbsp oil, the shallot, half the scallions and garlic, the sherry, and 1 cup water. Add the parsley sprigs, fennel seeds, salt, pepper, and paprika. Bring to a boil. Cover and cook for 4–5 minutes, shaking a few times, until the shells open. Strain through a muslin-lined sieve into a bowl and let cool completely. Discard any unopened clams or mussels.

2 Put the tomatoes, the cold stock from the mussels, 1 tbsp olive oil, 1 hard-boiled egg yolk and the remaining scallions and garlic in a blender and process until very smooth. Press through a sieve into a bowl. Rinse out the blender or food processor with 1 cup water mixed with the sherry vinegar. Pour through the sieve into the bowl.

3 Chill the soup for at least 2 hours. Press the remaining egg yolk through a sieve and finely chop the whites. Mix the brown crab meat with 2 tbsp oil and the egg yolk and whites. Add a little pepper and spread on the croûtes.

4 Ladle the soup into bowls and lightly stir in the white crab meat. Float a croûte on each helping and scatter the chopped parsley over the top.